

CURRICULUM VITAE

CALEB MUTCH

Belfortstraße 18
79098 Freiburg im Breisgau

+49 761 2039 7867
caleb.mutch@germanistik.uni-freiburg.de

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

- 2026–: **University of Freiburg**, Freiburg im Breisgau, Germany
Postdoctoral Researcher (Akademischer Mitarbeiter im wissenschaftlichen Dienst)
- 2020–25: **Max Planck Institute for Empirical Aesthetics**, Frankfurt am Main, Germany
Research Scientist, 2022–25; Postdoctoral Research Fellow, 2020–22
- 2017–20: **Indiana University**, Bloomington, Ind.
Visiting Assistant Professor, 2019–20; Postdoctoral Resident Scholar, 2017–19
- 2015–17: **Columbia University, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences**, New York, N.Y.
Core Lecturer in the Humanities

EDUCATION

Columbia University, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences, New York, N.Y.
Ph.D. in Music Theory (2015)
Dissertation: “Studies in the History of the Cadence”
Dissertation advisors: David E. Cohen, Ph.D. and Benjamin Steege, Ph.D.
Certificate in Medieval & Renaissance Studies (2015); **M.Phil.** (2011); **M.A.** (2010)

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, B.C.
B.Mus. in Music Scholarship, Minor in Latin (2008)

Royal Conservatory of Music, Toronto, Ont.
A.R.C.T. (Associate degree) in Piano Performance (2004)

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed Articles

1. “Against the Monochord: Numbers, String Lengths, and the History of Music Theory.” *Music Theory Online* 31, no. 4 (December 2025): doi.org/10.30535/mto.31.4.6
2. “Early Modern Music Cognition: The Case of W. C. Printz.” *Journal of Music Theory* 69, no. 2 (October 2025): 263–84
3. “An Emendation to Pseudo-Aristotle, *Problēmata* 19.4.” *Classical Quarterly* 74, no. 2 (December 2024): 784–87
4. “Re-quantifying W. C. Printz’s Concept of *Quantitas Intrinseca*.” *Music Theory and Analysis* 11, no. 2 (October 2024): 172–95
5. “How the Triad Took (a) Root.” *Journal of Music Theory* 66, no. 1 (April 2022): 43–62
*Winner of the David Kraehenbuehl Prize 2022–23

6. "'Something Else is Possible': Transcultural Collaboration as Anti-Apartheid Activism in the Music of Juluka." *Popular Music* 40, no. 3–4 (December 2021): 450–69
7. "Canons and Contestable Cadences in Brahms' Op. 118, No. 4." *Music Theory and Analysis* 8, no. 1 (April 2021): 143–52
8. "The Triad in Dispute: Johannes Lippius, His Audiences, and the *Disputatio* Genre." *Music Theory Spectrum* 42, no. 2 (Fall 2020): 247–59
9. "Mathematical Approaches to Defining the Semitone in Antiquity." *Journal of Mathematics and Music* 14, no. 3 (November 2020): 292–306
10. "Pedagogy and Authority in Sixteenth-Century German Music Theory Textbooks." *Theoria* 26 (2020): 25–54
11. "The Formal Function of Fortspinnung." *Theory & Practice* 43 (2018): 1–32
12. "Blainville's New Mode, or How the Plagal Cadence Became 'Plagal.'" *Eighteenth-Century Music* 12, no. 1 (March 2015): 69–90

Book Chapter

"From Juluka to Savuka: Johnny Clegg's Changing Compositional Practices." In *Johnny Clegg: Critical Reflections on his Music and Influence*, edited by Michael Drewett and Lucilla Spini, 209–27. Johannesburg: Wits University Press, 2025.

Monograph in Progress

Wolfgang Caspar Printz: Musical Thought and Intellectual Synthesis in the German Baroque

Digital Humanities

"Inquiry-Orientated Dialogues." Project led by Prof. Dr. Racha Kirakosian. In preparation

- Overseeing OCR of medieval texts (including training recognition models), and using AI to develop open-access Natural Language Processing tools for big-data analysis.

"Pietro d'Abano on pseudo-Aristotle on Music: A Digital Critical Edition." Under review

- Critical edition coded in XML following Text Encoding Initiative standards, with ability to hide and swap textual variants

Digital Director of *Thinking Music: Global Sources for the History of Music Theory*. Under contract

- Overseeing digitization of global theory materials (including western and non-western languages, audio and visual sources) and their incorporation into a database

"Particula XIX: De Harmonia." In *Problemata: Translatio Bartholomaei*. In preparation; expression of interest received to be published in the *Aristoteles Latinus* series

- Critical edition includes phylogenetic analysis of underlying XML data to quantify the degree of relatedness of more than fifty manuscripts

Articles in Process

"MHDTagger: Transformer-Based Morphological Analysis for Medieval German Texts." In preparation

"The Problem of Formal Beginnings in the Music of J.S. Bach." In preparation

"Gang Signs: Deciphering A. B. Marx's Sonata Expositions." In preparation

Edited Volume in Progress

Editor-at-Large, *Thinking Music: Global Sources for the History of Music Theory*, ed. Thomas Christensen, Lester Hu, and Carmel Raz (Chicago CORPUS, 2027)

- Responsible for editing ca. 100 entries of Ancient Near East, Australian, Byzantine, Ethiopic, Persian, European, and Turkish music theory, among others.

Other Writing

"Towards a Pre-History of Music Cognition" (with Carmel Raz and David E. Cohen).
Introduction to a journal special section. *Journal of Music Theory* 69, no. 2 (October 2025): 207–13

"Going Global, in Theory" (with David E. Cohen, Roger M. Grant, Andrew Hicks, Nathan J. Martin, Caleb Mutch, Melanie Wald-Fuhrmann, Felix Wörner, and Anna Zayaruznaya).
IMS Blog: Musicological Brainfood 3, no. 1 (2019)

"Mbaqanga in the Classroom: Teaching Harmonic Function through South African Music."
Teaching resource; revise and resubmit

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"Music Theory as Polyphony: Interrogating the Long Tradition of Dialogical Theorizing."
Sixteenth Biennial International Conference on Music Theory and Analysis. Belgrade, October 2026

"Branching Out: Music Theory Pedagogy's Ramist Turn." Annual conference of the Dutch-Flemish Society for Music Theory. The Hague, March 2026

"Enter the Prechorus: Producing Intensification in Two Recent Taylor Swift Songs." Annual conference of the Society for Music Theory. Jacksonville, Fla., November 2024

"'Something Else is Possible': Transcultural Collaboration as Anti-Apartheid Activism in the Music of Juluka." Annual conference of the Music Theory Society of New York State. Online, Summer 2021

"Against the Monochord: Numbers, String Lengths, and the History of Music Theory." Annual conference of the American Musicological Society. Online, November 2020

"A Radical Theory: Lippius's Misunderstood Theory of Roots." Annual conference of Music Theory Midwest. Online, July 2020

"The Triad in Dispute: Genre and Audience in the Writings of Johannes Lippius." Annual conference of the Society for Music Theory. Arlington, Va., November 2017

"Comparing Bodies: Organicism and the Rise of Romantic *Formenlehre*." Annual conference of the Music Theory Midwest. Rochester, Mich., May 2015 and the annual Pacific Northwest Graduate Music Conference. Vancouver, B.C., February 2015

"Cadence Systematized: Printz's Doctrine of the *Clausula formalis*." Annual conference of the Society for Music Theory. Charlotte, N.C., October 2013

"'L'art ne progresse pas, mais il se transforme': Reconsidering Teleology in Fétis's Historiography." Annual conference of the Music Theory Society of New York State. Stony Brook, N.Y., April 2013

"Towards a Freer Form of Interruption." Second annual Mannes Graduate Student Theory Conference. New York, N.Y., January 2012

"A Major Step Forward: Changing Conceptions of Whole Tone and Scale Step in Ancient and Medieval Theory." Annual conference of the Society for Music Theory. Minneapolis, Minn., October 2011, and the annual Princeton-Columbia-Penn-Cornell Graduate Student Conference. New York, N.Y., April 2009

INVITED TALKS

- "Eighteenth-Century Theories of Meter and Music Performance Today." Keynote address to be presented at the Feliks Nowowiecki Academy of Music's "Reconnaissance – The Mozart Measure" symposium. Bydgoszcz, Poland, October 27–29, 2026
- "Inquiry-Orientated Dialogues." Paper presented with Prof. Dr. Racha Kirakosian and Dr. Jonas Hermann at the University of Freiburg Digital Humanities Colloquium. Freiburg, Germany, July 21, 2026
- "Three in One: Adventures in the Development of Theories of the Triad." Paper presented at the University of Freiburg Musicology Colloquium. Freiburg, Germany, May 12, 2026
- "Global Histories of Music Theory and the Digital Humanities." Paper presented at the University of Chicago Neubauer Collegium. Chicago, Ill., June 13, 2025
- "Early Modern Music Cognition?: The Case of J. W. C. Printz." Paper presented at the Max Planck Institute for Empirical Aesthetics. Frankfurt, Germany, October 25, 2022
- "The Problem of Beginnings in Baroque Form." Paper presented at the Indiana University Graduate Theory Association's Symposium of Research in Music Theory. Bloomington, Ind., February 8, 2019
- "The Printing Press as an Agent of Music-Theoretical Change." Paper presented at "Future Histories of Music Theory," a workshop at the Max Planck Institute for Empirical Aesthetics. Frankfurt, Germany, July 19, 2018
- "From Cadence to Form: How Biology Affected Romantic Music Theory." Paper presented at the Rutgers University Musicology Society. New Brunswick, N.J., March 23, 2016

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- Full funding (€600) to attend Transcriboquest 2026, a workshop on handwritten text recognition, École Normale Supérieure de Lyon, 2026
- David Kraehenbuehl Prize 2022–23 for "How the Triad Took (a) Root," *Journal of Music Theory*
- Full funding (\$500) to attend summer workshop on digital critical editions
Digital Latin Library, University of Oklahoma, 2017
- H.S. Gerstle Travel Fund, Columbia University, 2013 & 2015
- Directors' Scholarship Fund, Rare Book School, 2014
- Dissertation Fellow (2012–13) and Faculty Fellow (2008–12) in Music, Columbia University
- University of British Columbia Medal (in Music), 2007 & 2008
- Prize for Musicology, University of British Columbia, 2006
- Harry and Marjorie Anne Slim Memorial Scholarship in Music, U.B.C., 2005 & 2006
- Wallace Berry Memorial Prize in Music Theory, University of British Columbia, 2005

TEACHING

INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD:

University of Freiburg:

The Science of Music before 1450 (2025)

Indiana University:

Baroque and Classical Musical Form (2020, 2018); *Renaissance Counterpoint* (2020, 2019); *History of Music Theory I* (2019, 2017); *Graduate Theory Review* (2019); *Music and Media Revolutions* (2018)

Columbia University:

Music Humanities (2013, 2015, 2016, 2017); *Theory II* (2015); *Theory I* (2014);

Rutgers University:

Study in Music Analysis (2016)

University of British Columbia:

Topics in the History of Music Theory (Summer 2013); *Aural Skills II, III, and IV* (2007–2008) (Co-taught with Dr. William E. Benjamin)

TEACHING ASSISTANT:

Columbia University:

Chromatic Harmony & Counterpoint (2010–12); *Diatonic Harmony & Counterpoint* (2009–2010)

University of British Columbia:

Jazz Theory and Arranging (2007–2008)

SERVICE

Editorial board member, *Music Theory Online*, 2025–present

Editorial board member, *Indiana Theory Review*, 2021–present

Co-chair and founding member, AMS history of theory study group, 2017–2021

Board member, Centre for the History of Music Theory and Literature,
Indiana University, 2017–2019

Conference session chair, “Spinning Out Bach,” Society for Music Theory annual meeting, 2019;
“History of Theory: Politics, Practicalities, and Speculation,” Society for Music Theory
annual meeting, 2018

Organizer, History of Theory in the Ancient World reading group, 2023–present

Co-organizer, “Histories of Music, Mind, and Body” monthly workshop series, 2022–25

Assistant organizer, “Towards a Global History of Music Theory” workshop (12 participants),
Frankfurt am Main, Germany, June 2023

Assistant organizer, “Attention, Cognition, and the Auditory Self, 1770–1920” virtual Zoom
conference (20 participants), May 2023

Assistant organizer, “Histories of Music and Attention” virtual Zoom conference (18
participants), December 2022

Co-organizer, “Instruments of Music Theory” conference, November 8–9, 2017

Manuscript reviewer, *Music Theory Spectrum*, 2025 & 2023; *Music Theory Online*, 2025, 2023 &
2017; *Classical Quarterly*, 2024; *Journal of Musicology*, 2022; *GAMUT: Journal of the Music
Theory Society of the Mid-Atlantic*, 2022; *Music Theory and Analysis*, 2021; *Journal of Music
Theory*, 2020 & 2019

Submissions editor, *Current Musicology*, 2011–15